

Kings Second Baseman Shows Improvement, Hustle Avery Wins Top Award

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Sports

Edited by
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Baseball Standings

AMERICAN LEAGUE

	W	L	Pct.	GB
Minnesota	2	0	1.000	
Baltimore	1	0	1.000	1/2
New York	1	0	1.000	1/2
Cleveland	1	1	.500	1
Boston	1	1	.500	1
California	1	1	.500	1
Detroit	1	1	.500	1
Chicago	0	1	.000	1 1/2
Oakland	0	1	.000	1 1/2
Washington	0	2	.000	2

Yesterday's Results

Minnesota 5, Washington 4

Special to The Herald-Post
HOLTVILLE, Calif., April 12. — Little Gordie Avery, the player who showed so much desire and work last year at second base for the El Paso Sun Kings, became a "big" Gordie Avery today here at the California Angels minor league spring training camp.

Avery was singled out of the 140 plus players of the California Angels minor league spring training camp for the Wantz Award as the most improved and hardest working player in camp. The Holtville camp has teams from Seattle, El Paso, San Jose, Quad Cities and a rookie league.

"THE WAY HE is improved he could go on up," El Paso manager Chuck Tanner said today. "His work at the end of last season with Andy Cohen (Sun Kings coach) has improved him tremendously and he now handles the double play like Andy did in the majors." "It is a fine tribute to Andy," Tanner added. "Gordie worked hard with Andy and this year has shown tremendous improvement in his glove work and speed."

AVERY, A 5-FOOT, 10-inch Oregon product, led the Texas League last year in doubles with 38 while defensively he was the leader in putouts (280), assists

(411) and double plays (83.). The 23-year-old second baseman picked up on his batting at the tail end of the season to finish with a respectable .248 and "looks very good" this year, according to Tanner.

The Wantz Award is presented in honor of a California Angels pitcher who died after pitching just one game in the majors. Previous award winners have been Tom Burgmeier who is playing with the Angels parent club this year and Jim Spencer,

the first baseman for El Paso.

EL PASO COULD have the strongest southpaw pitcher in the Texas League this year with the addition last night of Rudy May to the roster. May was with the Angels several years ago and pitched a 15 strikout win against the New York Yankees before injuring his arm.

He pitched for El Paso two years ago and finally got his arm back in shape for a 7-2 record last year with San Jose.

"MAY STRUCK out 10 Sun Kings in six innings during practice yesterday and is looking like the Rudy May of the Angels days," Tanner said. "He is the kind of hard throwing lefthander that we are short of." He replaced Ed Sukla who was transferred back to Seattle after being transferred to El Paso.



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